

more intrusive access to users' personal data than it has disclosed, effectively exempting those business partners from its usual privacy rules, according to internal records and interviews."

In this case, it was Facebook, but there have been other documented instances where other organisations have come under scanner and have been proven guilty for using the personal information of their users in ways that the average consumer could never imagine. Back in April 2020, one of the biggest organisations of the world, Google, came under the scrutiny of the Irish Data Protection Commission as they were made aware of Google's location data processing methods, which were notably disregarding data protection standards. There have also been cases where advertisers and sellers have been sold consumer data, which has led to a lot of consumer and market manipulation.

Privacy and individual independence is at risk

Data and information, be it in any form, if taken from an individual, can be a concern for them. Especially when they do not even know who is taking what information from them. Even after the best measures of privacy preservation taken by both the individuals, uploading information and data online, and the organisations who are tasked with holding the data and protecting it, your data is still at risk.

The way that the privacy concerns translate into being a threat to individual independence is that, as soon as your data and information becomes a part of a database or a storage unit, where the data of millions of people like yourself are virtually present, heavy categorisations start taking place. For the people on the other side of the screen, you no longer are, say Mr Smith, you are a statistic that is placed in the category of people who like cat videos and are human rights advocates. After that happens, everywhere you go, you will be known as a humanitarian group member or cat lover group member. And, trust us, the internet is not a good place after you have lost your individuality. At some point, even the truth starts to fade and your new reality is the category you are a part of.

They know who you are

Digital profiling is a very dangerous thing that the consumers and users of various online services are subject to these days. They may not exactly be dealing with the information that might bring direct harm upon you, but what happens is that you start living your life their way. Your shop-